

SHOGI · VARIANT 14 OF 24

Judkins' Shogi

6×6
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

Judkins' Shogi

Modern miniature Shogi variant on a 6×6 board. Named after its inventor.

OVERVIEW

Judkins' Shogi compresses modern Shogi onto a 6×6 board with 7 pieces per side, retaining drops. It plays very similarly to standard Shogi but in a much faster format.

SETUP

Each player has 7 pieces: King, Gold, Silver, Knight, Bishop, Rook, and one Pawn.

FEN: rbsgkn/5p/6/6/P5/NKGSBR w - - 0 1

(Approximate; pawn is on the square directly in front of the King)

White (rank 1, left to right): Rook(a1), Bishop(b1), Silver(c1), Gold(d1), King(e1), Knight(f1) **White (rank 2):** Pawn at e2 (directly in front of the King)

Black mirrors White on the opposite side of the board.

PIECES

All pieces move exactly as in standard Shogi:

PIECE	MOVEMENT	PROMOTES TO
King	One step any direction	Does not promote
Gold General	One step ortho. or diagonally forward	Does not promote
Rook	Slides ortho. any distance	Dragon (Rook + diagonal step)
Bishop	Slides diagonally any distance	Horse (Bishop + ortho. step)
Silver General	One step diagonally or straight forward	Gold General
Knight	Forward L-shape only (1+2 forward, jumps over)	Gold General
Pawn	One step straight forward	Gold General

PROMOTION

The **promotion zone** is the **last 2 ranks** (ranks 5–6 for White). Promotion is optional at the end of a turn when the move enters, moves within, or leaves the promotion zone, except:

- ♦ A Pawn must promote upon reaching rank 6 (the last rank), as it could not otherwise move.
 - ♦ A Knight must promote upon reaching rank 5, as it could not otherwise move forward.
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DROPS

Captured pieces are held in hand and may be dropped on any empty square on the player's turn, with these restrictions:

- ♦ A piece may not be dropped on a square from which it has no legal moves (Pawns cannot be dropped on the last rank).
 - ♦ A Pawn may not be dropped into a file already containing an unpromoted friendly Pawn.
 - ♦ A Pawn may not be dropped to give immediate checkmate.
 - ♦ A piece dropped inside the promotion zone does **not** promote immediately; it may promote on a subsequent move.
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All promoted pieces revert to their unpromoted form when captured and returned to hand.

Source: chessvariants.com/shogivariants.dir/judkin.html